

OFFICIALLY FUNNY

Delaware's Stand-Up Comedy Competition

Official Competition Rules

1. Overview

Officially Funny is Delaware's stand-up comedy competition, a 5-day tournament showcasing original talent, rewarding excellence, and crowning a comedy champion. 32 comedians compete across 5 elimination rounds. 32 comedians enter, 1 champion is crowned.

2. Schedule & Venues

Round	Date	Show	Venue	Comedians	Set Time
1 – Preliminary	Tue, Aug 4	Cool J's After Dark	1857 Pulaski Hwy, Bear, DE 19701	32	3:30 min/sec
2 – Elimination	Wed, Aug 5	Plated Soul	2 Chesmar Plaza, Newark, DE 19713	20	3:30 min/sec
3 – Semifinals	Thu, Aug 6	Milk N Honey Restaurant & Lounge	239 Market St, Wilmington, DE 19801	10	5:00 min
4 – Championship Qualifier	Fri, Aug 7	Cool J's After Dark	1857 Pulaski Hwy, Bear, DE 19701	5	5:00 min
5 – Grand Finale	Sat, Aug 8	Cool J's After Dark	1857 Pulaski Hwy, Bear, DE 19701	3	7:00 min

Elimination structure: 32 start → 20 advance → 10 advance → 5 advance → 1 champion.

3. Entry & Eligibility

- Entrants must be 18 years of age or older.
- Entry fee: \$25 per comedian, paid at the time of registration.
- Registration is by private link only (not publicly listed) and is processed through Eventbrite.
- One entry per comedian. Material performed must be original to the performer.
- The 32 Round 1 spots are awarded through a selection process, not first-come registration.
- As part of the application, each entrant must submit a 30–60 second video of their comedy performance (a link to YouTube, Instagram, or similar) for review by the selection panel.
- Entry fees are non-refundable under all circumstances.

4. Check-In & Disqualification

- Check-in begins at 7:30 PM at each venue.
- Check-in deadline is 7:55 PM at each venue.
- Show starts at 8:00 PM sharp.

Comedians not checked in by 7:55 PM will be disqualified. No exceptions.

5. Judging Criteria

Each of the 5 categories below is scored 0–10 points per judge, for a maximum possible score of 50 points per judge.

1	Originality & Authentic Voice	Original material and a unique comedic voice that is authentically the performer's own: original content, distinctive style, authenticity, fresh perspective.
2	Stage Command	How well the comedian commands the stage, controls the audience, and delivers their set: presence & confidence, pacing & timing, moves the audience, keeps attention.
3	Comedic Competence	Demonstrated ability and technical skill as a stand-up comedian: listening & crowd awareness, voice/characters/impersonations, callbacks & play-off errors, improvisation & recovery, transitions & delivery.
4	Comedic Reach	How broadly the comedian's style appeals to different audiences and venues: mass appeal potential, relatable across demographics, works in various settings, not limited to a niche.

5	Professionalism	Professional conduct from arrival to exit and everything in between: arrives prepared, mic & stage awareness, respects time & cues, interacts professionally, smooth entry & exit.
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Judges evaluate each comedian equally across all five criteria.

6. Tie-Breakers

- In the event of a tie, the following scores are used, in order, to determine placement:
- 1) Highest Comedic Competence score.
- 2) If still tied, highest Comedic Reach score.
- 3) If still tied, highest Professionalism score.

7. Prizes

1st Place — \$250

- 7-minute guest spot on the Comedy@Cool J's show
- 90-minute comedy set workshop session
- 15-minute headline set in the Comedy Showcase

2nd & 3rd Place

- 7-minute guest spot on the Comedy@Cool J's show

8. Code of Conduct

- Comedians are expected to conduct themselves professionally from arrival to exit, per the Professionalism judging criteria.
- Harassment, hate speech, or targeted discriminatory material directed at audience members, staff, or fellow comedians will not be tolerated.
- Cool J's reserves the right to disqualify or remove any comedian for violating this Code of Conduct, at any point in the competition, without refund.
- Explicit content is treated as a matter of comedic style and will be scored accordingly under the judging criteria.
- Judges and/or contest managers may deem content excessive and disqualify a contestant immediately, at their discretion.
- Any vulgarity directed at the audience may result in disqualification.

9. Media & Recording Release

By registering, each comedian consents to being photographed, recorded, and livestreamed during the competition, and grants Cool J's the right to use this footage for promotional and marketing purposes across web, print, and social media, without additional compensation.

Entry into the competition also constitutes consent for Cool J's to use the entrant's name, image, and likeness, as well as performance photographs and similar materials, for promotional and marketing purposes, without additional compensation.

10. Event Changes & Cancellation

Cool J's reserves the right to reschedule, relocate, or cancel any round due to circumstances beyond its control (e.g., venue availability, weather, emergency). Registered comedians will be notified as soon as possible of any changes.

11. Payments & Ticketing

- Comedian registration and entry fee: processed through a private Eventbrite registration link, shared only with entrants (not publicly listed).
- Audience tickets: sold through a separate, publicly listed Eventbrite event.
- Audience ticket pricing: \$15 per round, or \$50 for an All-Event Pass covering all 5 rounds.

12. Final Authority

Decisions of the judging panel are final. Cool J's reserves the right to amend these rules as needed to ensure the fairness and smooth operation of the competition.